

CURRENT AFFAIRS



ALEPPO & SYRIA CRISIS



1st WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 1

ALL EXAMS

2nd Jan to 8th Jan





THE ARABIAN PENINSULA



ARAB SPRING

1 Arab Spring was a revolutionary wave of **violent as well as non violent demonstrations**, protests, riots, coups and in some cases civil wars in some of the Arab countries

2 It all began on **17th December, 2010** in **Tunisia**

3 It lead to major insurgencies and civil wars in countries like **Libya, Syria, Yemen**

4 Governments were overthrown in **Tunisia, Egypt, Yemen, Libya**

5 It lead to major protests in countries like **Algeria, Sudan** as well as minor protests in countries like **Saudi Arabia**



North
Atlantic
Ocean





North
Atlantic
Ocean





TURKEY

Cyprus

Mediterranean Sea

Lebanon

SYRIA

IRAQ

Israel

JORDAN

Gulf of Aqaba

KUWAIT



WHAT ARE THE MAIN REASONS FOR ARAB SPRING?

- 1 The main reason is authoritarian regimes in most of the Arab countries
- 2 Human Rights Violation with little freedom in several countries
- 3 The advent of powerful social media led to protests on mass scale and youth were on to the streets
- 4 Political corruption in some of the regimes is one of the reasons
- 5 Unemployment also precipitated the anger among the youth
- 6 The sectarian divide among Shiites, Sunnis is another reason for violent protests and subsequent civil wars are supported by some countries based on sectarian affiliations

SYRIA CRISIS

- 1** In March 2011, some teenagers were arrested when they painted some revolutionary slogans in a school in Daara
- 2** Protestors took to the streets in a big way and police opened fire killing several people
- 3** More street protests followed and Government used force to control them and several civilians were killed
- 4** Rebel brigades were formed to control the cities, towns and the countryside by acquiring arms. Here the rivalry of the Shias, Sunnis precipitated the crisis
- 5** As Bashar al-Assad belongs to Shiite Alawite sect, he was supported indirectly by Iran and some of the towns have majority population of Sunnis and Rebels (sunni groups) are supported by Saudi Arabia and others.
- 6** The long border of Turkey with Syria was used as conduit to the Rebel forces for arranging arms and ammunition
- 7** Seeing the political vacuum, IS spread its tentacles not only in Syria but also in adjacent Iraq

SYRIA CRISIS

- 7 Another group Kurds hold onto their strong holds and hence Syria became battle ground among the Government forces, Rebels, Islamic state with Kurds maintaining their supremacy in their areas of dominance



VARIOUS GROUPS IN SYRIA



al-Nusra Front



Free Syrian Army



الائتلاف الوطني لقوى
الثورة والمعارضة السورية

**National Coalition for Syrian
Revolutionary and Opposition Forces**



Islamic State of Iraq and Syria

There are several other splinter groups in addition to them !

LOOK AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS IN SYRIA!

GROUP - 1

PRESIDENT SYRIA



Bashar al-Assad
Syria President

SUPPORT FROM IRAN



Hassan Rouhani
Iran President

SUPPORT FROM RUSSIA



Vladimir Putin
Russian President



OTHERS LIKE HEZBOLLAH...

LOOK AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS IN SYRIA!

GROUP - 2

SUPPORT FROM
USA & WEST

SUPPORT FROM SAUDI
ARABIA & ITS GROUP

REBEL GROUPS IN
SYRIA



Barack Obama
President, USA



Salman
King, Saudi Arabia



OTHERS

LOOK AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS IN SYRIA!

GROUP - 3

IS by establishing self proclaimed Caliphate at Raqqa, Syria



ALEPPO ... HUMANITARIAN CRISIS



- 1 Aleppo is close to Turkey border
- 2 Prior to Civil war, it was the largest city in Syria with the population of around 20 lakhs with 80% sunnis
- 3 Now it is the second largest after Damascus. Old city of Aleppo is the World Heritage Site
- 4 It was caught in civil war
- 5 Major portions of the city were occupied by the rebel forces and civil war broke out between Government led forces and rebel forces, because of which several people lost their lives in the battle between Government led forces and rebels
- 6 Before civil war, 80% of the Aleppo's inhabitants are Sunni Muslims and this is the main reason for the capture of most parts of Aleppo by the rebel forces
- 7 There are allegations that serious war crimes are being committed in Aleppo both by the Government forces and rebels
- 8 United Nations stated that Aleppo is one of the worst humanitarian crises in the world in recent times



TURKEY

Aleppo

SYRIA

Damascus

IRAQ

Cyprus

Lebanon

Mediterranean Sea

Israel

JORDAN

KUWAIT

Gulf of Aqaba

WHERE SYRIAN CRISIS IS HEADING FOR?



- 1 After the entry of Russia in September, 2015 to support Bashar al-Assad Government, the situation turned towards Bashar al-Assad
- 2 The decisive victory in Aleppo made the Government more and more stronger and it clearly indicates that for the western forces who supported rebels, it can be stated as a monumental failure
- 3 The support which the GCC/western countries gave to rebels ultimately led to the proliferation of Islamic State as well as the emergence of various splinter groups from the rebel forces, which further destabilized the country
- 4 At present juncture, the victory of Bashar al-Assad in major cities emboldened the Government forces. But vast swaths of the countryside is still held by rebel forces as well as Islamic State
- 5 Islamic State extended its tentacles to several countries and it became the destabilizing force with its attacks in several countries
- 6 With ceasefire in Aleppo, it is the time for all the stakeholders to sit together and find some political solution to the six year old civil war



*Syria is another monumental
failure of the world
community as a whole!*

*It also raises pertinent doubt
whether the United Nations
exists or not!*

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO



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